themselves available for acts of fellatio but who refuse to reciprocate in the act. The author of this unusual study of 'homosexual encounters in public places' is a minister of religion turned sociologist currently Assistant Professor at the University of Southern Illinois. He does not attempt to test any hypothesis but is clearly influenced by Goffman. After a preliminary year of intensive observation, he witnessed some 120 sexual acts in 19 different lavatories in five parks of one city. He then concentrated on one particular park lavatory and by passing himself off as a deviant and acting as look-out man, made systematic observations on homosexual encounters there.

He was able to integrate his research sample into a much wider social health survey after identifying the subjects by tracing their car licence numbers. This enabled him to interview them personally and complete a questionnaire. The bulk of the book consists of a detailed analysis of 50 deviants (from an original sample of 134) and a matched control group obtained from the same health survey.

The presentation is popular, with snappy alliterations and much journalese, but footnotes with references and a useful index are provided. The ethical position is also discussed. Extravagant generalizations are avoided, but how far the findings would be applicable to the U.K. is not clear; it would be a hazardous undertaking to try and repeat this work.

F. E. KENYON.

ADDICTIONS

L.S.D. and Alcoholism. A Clinical Study of Treatment Efficacy. By A. M. LUDWIG, J. LEVINE and L. H. STARK. Charles C. Thomas. Springfield, Illinois. 1970. Pp. 331. Price $15.00.

This study, which won the Hofheimer Award of the American Psychiatric Association as an outstanding piece of research, sets out to test the efficacy of L.S.D. treatment of chronic alcoholics, and it does it very thoroughly.

The 176 subjects were selected on the basis of age (21–55), no psychosis, no physical disability, having a responsible relative in the background, and living reasonably nearby. They were all admitted for thirty days to a hospital alcoholic unit and there submitted to one of four regimes: L.S.D., hypnosis and psychotherapy; L.S.D. and psychotherapy; L.S.D. alone; and lastly just the 'milieu therapy' of the ward. The L.S.D. treatment, in whatever combination, was used on only one day for any patient.

The method includes an extensive battery of tests and questionnaires to assess characteristics and attitudes of the subjects both before and after the treatment.

The follow-up, involving five face-to-face enquiries over an eighteen month period from discharge, was particularly complete and thorough including the subjects' pattern of drinking, their use of AA, and a controlled study of the effectiveness of antabuse. There was however no continuing contact between patients and therapeutic staff after leaving the unit. The research design seems impeccable except perhaps that, being placed in the same alcoholic unit and cared for by the same staff, the experiences of the L.S.D. subjects may have been vicariously shared to some extent by the others, who may have benefited from a general Hawthorne effect.

The dismal result is that, though subjects in all four treatment groups show marked but temporary changes, the L.S.D. procedures have no glimmer of superiority over the 'intensive milieu therapy program' which itself 'is quite ineffective in deterring drinking'; and neither subject, treatment, nor therapist variables bore any consistent, significant relationship to outcome. These results are discussed in relation to the need for more sensitive assessment techniques, to the possibility that preparation for L.S.D. treatment had been insufficient, and that follow-up care was inadequate. It is nowhere suggested that the study may have utilized a very large and expensive hammer to shatter a nut which any squirrel would immediately recognize as empty.

For alcoholics selected in this way it may be quite inappropriate, on the medical analogy, to expect any brief course of treatment to be effective. Perhaps we should not, as in this book, consider the 'unique challenge' of 'the alcoholic in the community', so much as the common challenge of the community and its alcoholics, drug addicts, delinquents and criminals; the absurdity, not only of mounting brief treatment for them, but of regarding them primarily as psychiatric problems rather than long standing social problems, often with medical and psychiatric features or complications, may then be apparent. However, the study certainly stands as a methodological paradigm; it was a lovely hammer.

P. D. SCOTT.

The Treatment of Delirum Tremens and Related States. By RONALD W. MCNICHOL. Charles C. Thomas. 1970. Pp. 145. Price $8.00.

Is delirium tremens under-treated in British hospitals? If the intensive methods advocated here in considerable detail by Dr. McNichol of Arkansas are correct, the answer is Yes. Some items in the author's treatment schedules, for example the routine use of intravenous steroid drips and indwelling